

Neil Acosta, CISM, CCSK

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EDUCATION

BS in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance

Western Governors University – Utah, US

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Information Security Manager® (CISM)

Certificate of Cloud Security Knowledge – CCSK

CompTIA PenTest+

CompTIA Security+

AWS Certified Developer

Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator

Google Cloud Engineer - Associate

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Architect

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Cloud Operations

Oracle Autonomous Database Cloud

IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Professional

Aviatrix Multi-cloud Network and Security

Linux Certified System Administrator (LFCS)

Cloud Engineer – The Linux Foundation

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Cloud Security Architecture

Cloud Engineer

Governance, & Support

Vulnerability Management

Cloud Security Automation

Incident Response

Security Asset Hardening

Governance Risk & Compliance (GRC)

System Security Planning (SSP)

Threat Modeling & Risk Assessments

Professional Experience

CyberPro Solutions.

Senior Cloud Security

September 2022 - April 2024

- Implemented automation of various security operations in DevSecOps CI/CD pipeline through automation of SCA, Secret, Container, SAST & DAST scans. Using Wiz, Aqua, JFrog, Prisma Cloud and Snyk.
- Developed and maintained a robust artifact management system using JFrog and Wiz, ensuring secure storage and distribution of software components. Improved release efficiency by 40% through automated artifact versioning and dependency management.
- Implemented cloud security best practices and designed secure architectures for multi-cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP), ensuring the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of critical data and applications.
- Conducted regular code analysis and vulnerability assessments using Snyk, leading to a 30% decrease in security vulnerabilities across applications deployed on AWS, Azure, and GCP. Implemented automated security checks within CI/CD pipelines to proactively identify and mitigate security risks.
- Developed and maintained security automation scripts and templates for Infrastructure as Code (IaC) frameworks (e.g., Terraform, CloudFormation), enabling consistent and secure provisioning of cloud resources while reducing manual errors.
- Successfully implemented automation of vulnerability management through AWS Systems Manager & Amazon Inspector.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments and penetration testing of cloud infrastructure and applications, identifying and remediating security weaknesses, and proactively addressing potential threats. Using Burp Suite.
- Implemented secure secrets management using AWS Secrets Manager, Azure Key Vault, and GCP Secret Manager, ensuring proper encryption and access controls for sensitive information, resulting in a 25% reduction in security breaches.
- Established and maintained cloud security monitoring and incident response processes, leveraging tools like CloudTrail, CloudWatch, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) systems, to detect

Security Operations
Information Security Program
Management
Network Administration
Systems Engineering
Linux Administration
FinOps

PROFESSIONAL PUBLICATIONS

Blog: medium.com/@neilacostait

- “Protect your code against attacks with Gauntlt, and PenTest in Cloud9 AWS — DevSecOps”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/c6d09c0e017c

- “Azure Key Vault and Disk Encryption — Using PowerShell”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/339914bd9f82

- “Investigating Security Events using Microsoft Sentinel and Simulating Password Brute-Force Attack on the Azure VM”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/e6c5e481387d

- “Using Amazon Key Management and Cloud Trail Service to Encrypt S3 and EBS Data”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/103d3604837

- “Using Security Contexts to Secure Kubernetes Clusters”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/965a58a85d8b

- “SQL Injection Vulnerability and WAF Defense — Leveraging AWS WAF to Defend an Insecure Web App”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/6d83fc317b9b

- “Cross Site Scripting (XSS) Vulnerability and WAF Defense — Leveraging AWS WAF to Defend an Insecure Web App”

Blog Article - medium.com/p/8384a84473a3

TECHNOLOGIES

Aws, Azure, GCP, Oracle Cloud
Docker
Linux
Kubernetes
GIT
DevOps
Jenkins
Terraform
Cisco
Juniper
Fortinet
CrowdStrike
React JavaScript

and respond to security events in real-time.

- Deployed Web Application Firewall (WAF) into the cloud.

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Senior Cloud Security

November 2019 - October 2022

- Configured, implemented, design and managed cloud-native technologies and services, including virtual machines, web servers, tunnels, CDN, load balancer, Apache server, database server, SSL/TLS, cloud firewalls, and WAF (Web Application Firewall), Cisco/Juniper LAN/WAN technologies, using AWS, Azure and GCP for an extensive organization to achieve a high level of availability and uptime for the platform. Palo Alto Firewalls.
- Improved the security posture of critical systems by implementing a Continuous Monitoring and Continuous Diagnostic program for the clients that reduced the number of vulnerabilities found by 200% and increased the overall security score by 80%. Using Wiz, Aqua, JFrog, Prisma Cloud and Snyk.
- Increased cloud migration of company-owned applications by 60% introducing cloud-based solutions to customers, leveraging Cloud Computing.
- Deployed Web Application Firewall (WAF) into the cloud, cloud security, to improve security by 91% of protecting against threats.
- Deployed Cloud Security Solutions (Azure FW, Prisma Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet and crowdstrike).
- Improved delivery time of security metrics by 30% by automating the reporting process with CI/CD systems, reducing the time spent on manual reporting. Using Wiz, Aqua, JFrog, Prisma Cloud and Snyk.
- Developed a system automation solution using Azure, Azure DevOps, and AWS, reducing the average time to restore service from 2 hours to 15 minutes.
- Implemented modern Authentication methods, standards, and protocols such as OAuth/Open ID Connect, 2FA/MFA, adaptive/ contextual/ password-less authentication to improve the security of web applications and services, by adding additional layers of authentication.
- Reduced the number of monthly outages by a factor of 3 and the number of security incidents by a factor of 5; working with the IT Infrastructure team and the company's outsourcing provider to improve the company's Systems, Network, and Security availability, reliability, and security.
- Regularly performed vulnerability assessments and penetration testing on cloud infrastructure and applications, utilizing Burp Suite to identify and remediate security weaknesses and proactively address potential threats.

Publitech Solutions SAS

Cloud Systems Engineer

August 2017 – September 2019

- Helped the server to increase its uptime from 90% to 99% by setting up a monitoring system for the server's status, and maintain the server updated at the fastest time possible. AWS CloudWatch (AWS) - Azure Monitor (Azure)
- Configured several cloud services to deliver a functional web application with a 99.999% SLA, including: Virtual Machines, Web Servers, Tunnels, CDN, HTTP Load Balancer, Apache Server, Database Server, SSL/TLS. Linux Administrator and

Magento
Python
Bash/Shell
Wiz
Aqua
Palo Alto Prisma Cloud
Splunk
QRadar
DATADog
ELK stack

some python. Working in Azure, Google Cloud Platform and Oracle Cloud Infrastructure. Deployed Cloud Security Solutions, Fortinet and CrowdStrike.

- Implemented Cloud solutions using Azure and AWS and moved data from on-prem to the cloud to increase uptime, enhance customer experience and reduce costs by 40%. AWS Snowball/Snowball Edge, Azure Import/Export Service.
- Implemented systems to improve performance and reliability, resulting in a decrease of system down time by 25%, and an increase in server response times by 50%. Leveraging AWS CloudWatch, Auto Scaling and RDS.
- Automated the setup of new services and clusters, reducing the time to provision environment from weeks to hours. Using Terraform.
- Automated infrastructure deployment and management using Infrastructure as Code (IaC) tools: AWS CloudFormation, Terraform and Azure Resource Manager (ARM templates) for efficient resource provisioning and configuration.
- Developed and executed policies, Security Groups, Network Access Control Lists and Network Virtual Private Clouds to secure network traffic and provide a secure and reliable service to customers.

Bogota Social Television

System Administrator

August 2015 - July 2017

- Provided technical support to over 200 users, installing & configuring computer hardware, software, and networks. Windows and Linux Server.
- Automated routine Linux administration tasks using shell scripting (Bash) and configuration management tools (e.g., Ansible) to improve efficiency and consistency. Proactively monitored system logs and performance metrics to identify and troubleshoot potential issues before they impacted users.
- Improved network performance and reliability by installing, maintaining, and troubleshooting internal office network and phone system equipment, including servers, switches, routers, access points, VPNs, and firewalls.
- Ensured data security and system uptime by installing and supporting a wide range of hardware and software, including Windows, Linux, and Mac servers, desktops, laptops, printers, and network devices.
- Enhanced system performance and security for critical applications by administering a fleet of Linux servers utilizing Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) and Ubuntu distributions. Performed tasks like user and group management, package installation and configuration, system hardening, and routine maintenance.